

W. Jordan Charles

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LEARNING SCIENCES | INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN | RESEARCH

Instructional designer with a psychology research background, working at the point where learning theory meets applied design. Experience spans experimental research, mixed-methods needs analysis in organizational settings, and curriculum design in higher education.

EDUCATION

M.Ed., Educational Psychology - Instructional Design & Educational Technology: University of Utah, August 2023 - May 2025. GPA 3.9

B.S., Psychology: Brigham Young University - Idaho, 2012 - 2018. GPA 3.5. Certificate in Programming

APPLIED RESEARCH & DESIGN

Instructional Designer

WeYouth (501(c)(3) nonprofit) | March 2026 - Present

- Translate a research-backed coaching model, developed over seven years of R&D, into deliverable self-paced curriculum
- Build per-module evaluation instruments that generate formative data during delivery rather than after it

Financial Wellness Intern

Chartway Federal Credit Union | May 2025 - July 2025

- Designed and ran a mixed-methods needs analysis: five semi-structured interviews and a 21-response survey
- Applied thematic analysis to identify the binding constraint on certification success

Graduate Research Assistant

Florida State University | Aug 2018 - Dec 2018

- Supported development of educational software for stealth assessment in children's learning

Research Associate

Research & Business Development Center, Rexburg, ID | Jan 2017 - Apr 2017

- Designed a pilot study, administered a survey to over one thousand participants, and presented findings to a city committee

Undergraduate Researcher

BYU-Idaho Psychology Department | Apr 2013 - Jul 2015

- Conducted literature reviews, generated testable hypotheses, gathered and analyzed data, and presented findings at conferences

PRESENTATIONS

Charles, W.J. (2014, Dec). Does Money Inequality Affect Empathy and Compassion? Poster session, Research & Creative Works Conference, Rexburg, ID.

North, A.J., & Charles, W.J. (2014, Apr). The Effects of PowerPoint on Student-Teacher Connection. Poster session, Rocky Mountain Psychological Association, Salt Lake City, UT.

HONORS

Research & Creative Works Conference: Finalist and 1st Place; Finalist and 3rd Place in a separate year

METHODS & THEORY

Methods: Experimental design, survey design, semi-structured interviewing, thematic analysis, statistical analysis (SPSS), formative and summative evaluation, cognitive walkthrough

Theory: Cognitive load theory, andragogy, Mayer's multimedia principles, Universal Design for Learning, Bloom's taxonomy, backward design